

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

I want to go to Mars!



Learning Outcome

Understand detailed descriptions of real or imaginary events and experiences in present, past or future, in spoken interactions or written texts.

Ask your partner:

- Which planets in the solar system do you know about?
- Which planet would you like to study about in more detail? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about science and leisure time.
- I can express true, untrue and possible events in present.
- I can express strong disapproval or refusal using *if*.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa and Michelle dream about what life is like on Mars!



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** I wonder what it's like to live in a distant galaxy. It must be so different than how we are living here.
- Michelle:** Yeah totally. I think about it too. There's so much out there that hasn't been explored yet.
- Vanessa:** Yeah. I mean look at all those stars. How far do you think they are?
- Michelle:** Judging by their brightness, they could be millions of light years away.
- Vanessa:** Wow! That must be really far! Do you think there's life there?
- Michelle:** Well, we aren't sure. There are theories out there that speculate that life could exist in some planets like Mars.
- Vanessa:** If I'll go to Mars, you'll come too, right? If there's anyone I'd go to Mars with, it would be you.
- Michelle:** I'm flattered Vanessa. The problem is I have children and they aren't the adventurous type. If they won't go, it's hard for me to leave them.
- Vanessa:** I totally understand, but I have an idea! If I'll draw a beautiful picture of Mars to them, there could be a chance for them to reconsider.
- Michelle:** Haha. You're funny Vanessa! Let me tell you what. If you'll come up with a solid plan on how to get there and live, I'll convince my children to come along. What do you think?
- Vanessa:** That would be great! There must be tons of research on how to do that in the library. I'll try to go first thing in the morning.
- Michelle:** If you'll do that, I'll do my own research as well. This could be the start of something really special.
- Vanessa:** I know! I'm so excited ...





Let's Practice!

Michelle and Vanessa are planning their future life.

Instructions: Classify the situations below as untrue or possible. Write the number into the corresponding category box.

1. Judging by their brightness, they could be millions of light years away.
2. Life on other planets must be so different than life on earth.
3. This could be the start of something really special.
4. There must be tons of research on how to get to Mars and live there in the library.

Untrue situations

Possible situations



Let's Practice!

Michelle and Vanessa make polite requests.

Instructions: Use the options from the Word Bank to complete the sentences correctly. There are three options you don't need to use.

Word Bank

I'll do / I'll go / you'll come up / I'll draw / I am going to do/ would not go/ won't go / won't go / I come up

1. If _____ with a solid plan on how to get there and live, I'll convince my children to come along.
2. If _____ a beautiful picture of Mars to them, there could be a chance for them to reconsider.
3. If they _____, it will be hard for me to leave them.
4. If _____ to Mars, you'll come too, right?
5. If you'll do that, _____ my own research as well.



Extension Activity

Decide on eight essential items you would need to take a trip to the moon.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner list all the necessary things we need to sustain human life on earth.
- Imagine that you and your partner have a spacecraft and are taking a trip to the moon.
- Speculate about which items are the most important and explain why.
- Write a list of no more than 8 items to bring.
- Share your list with another group.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about science and leisure.

☐ ☐

I speculate about different events.

☐ ☐

I write a list of objects.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **brightness** (noun): the quality or state of giving out or reflecting light
e.g. Judging by their brightness, they could be millions of light years away.
- **adventurous** (adjective): willing to try new or difficult things
e.g. I have children and they aren't the adventurous type.
- **to reconsider** (verb): to think again about a decision or opinion and decide if you want to change it
e.g. There could be a chance for them to reconsider.
- **distant** (adjective): far away
e.g. I wonder what it's like to live in a distant galaxy.
- **to speculate** (verb): to guess possible answers to a question when you do not have enough information to be certain
e.g. There are theories out there that speculate that life could exist in some planets like Mars.





Learning Points

Must, Might, Could, May and Can't to Speculate about the Present

You can use special words called *modal verbs* when you want to make speculations about events or situations in the present.

Speculating means that you think about something and make guesses about it.

There are different degrees of probability for each modal verb. Depending on how sure you are of what you want to say, you will need to choose a different modal verb.

When you are almost certain, you use **must**. This is used for the most logical interpretation. When you are less certain, you use **may** or **might** or **could**. These modal verbs all have the same meaning.

When you are making a negative speculation, you use **can't**. This means you are almost certain that something doesn't happen.

Examples:

- *Judging by their brightness, they **could** be millions of light years away.*
- *There **must** be tons of research on how to do that in the library.*
- *This **could** be the start of something really special.*





Learning Points

Will/Won't for Speculation vs. Will/Won't for Strong Disapproval or Refusal

You can use *will* or *won't* to express different things. One meaning is for making guesses about something in the present and another is to show refusal or disapproval.

Compare the sentences below.

*My cellphone is ringing late at night. That **will** be my friend calling me back. It **won't** be my mother calling me at this time.*

***If** you'll eat sugary snacks every day, it's no surprise that you've gained weight.*

***If** you **won't** do the dishes, then go to your room as punishment.*

How do you think the meaning of each sentence is different?

In the first sentence, you use **will** to show that you are sure that it is your friend returning your phone call. You are also sure that your mother is not the person on the phone.

In the second sentence, you use **if + will** to show insistence. This sentence means "If you insist on eating sugary snacks every day, it's no surprise that you've gained weight". You are showing that someone is firm about intending to do something, like "eating sugary snacks" in this example.

In the third sentence, you use **if + won't** to show refusal. Here, the person doesn't want to do the dishes.

Examples:

- ***If** I'll go to Mars, you'll come too, right?*
- ***If** they **won't** go, it's hard for me to leave them.*

